Skills

The fifteen skills: what each level buys, what gates on them, how they rise, and their mastery ladder

Kingdoms Call reference sheet. Data file v2026.10.15-1202. Generated 2026-10-19 from the repository (branch at that date). Numbers are what the engine uses today, read straight from its tables; where a figure comes from the rulebook text instead, the section says so.

Every character has fifteen skills from 0 to 9. Levels 1–5 can be trained and give the skill's base effect; 6–9 come only from field experience and give the mastery perks (see the Mastery sheet). This sheet puts the fifteen side by side with the figures the engine uses.

What to look for when reviewing

- Are the fifteen worth about the same? March and Explorer buy little past their first levels; Tactical and Druid are large multipliers.
- Which skills an item can carry past 5 (Melee, Archery, the five schools, and Druid in its own way).
- How each skill is learned in the field (R-023, R-056) and which Imperial Title it feeds.
- The king starts with 4 points (max 2 per skill); each hero with 3 at random.

Where this comes from

- Rulebook: The Fifteen Skills, How skills work, Training on the Practice ground, Mastery.
- Engine: army-tables.js (SKILL_BENEFIT_CAP 5, SKILL_MAX 9, ITEM_UNCAPPED_SKILLS), KC_BASIC_EXPLORE, MASTERY_UNLOCKS.

The fifteen skills

Skill	Group	What each level does (1–5)	Gates	Field experience (how it rises)	Items past 5?	Title it feeds	Mastery 6 / 7 / 8 / 9
Melee	Martial	To hit in personal combat 30% + 10%/level to 5 (then +5%/level to 100% at 9; final figure capped 80%). Damage 1–3 + ceil(raw Melee/2) + temper. Items and auras count past 5 to 9.	none	A landed blow in a fight; winning any personal fight; losing and living (small)	Yes (to 9)	Minor: The Duelist	6: Parry — in personal combat, each enemy melee blow that lands has a 50% chance to be reduced by 1 up to half your Melee skill. 7: New order — Challenge: call out an enemy commander in your province to single combat. 8: Counterattack — in personal combat, when an enemy misses you there is a 50% chance you riposte at once with a free melee strike. 9: New order — Rampage: after winning a duel, immediately strike a second enemy force.
Archery	Martial	Pre-battle volley: each ranged unit shoots 30% of its own strength, +10% per Archery level (half again at 5). +5% strength per level to every ranged unit led (+25% at 5). Personal combat to-hit same ladder as Melee; arrows 1–3 + ceil(Archery/2); two arrows per Fire action from Archery 3; +5%/level to both range checks; the parting shot.	none	A landed arrow; losing and living (small)	Yes (to 9)	Minor: The Marksman	6: Impalement — in personal combat, each arrow that hits has a 50% chance to impale, bleeding the foe 1-3 damage every round for three rounds. 7: New order — Rain of Arrows: a free pre-battle volley that softens the enemy front line. 8: Trueshot — in personal combat, each arrow that hits has a 50% chance to strike a vital point, so the foe's very next attack automatically fails. 9: New order — Sniper's Mark: target an enemy commander before battle for a chance to wound or slay them.

Skill	Group	What each level does (1–5)	Gates	Field experience (how it rises)	Items past 5?	Title it feeds	Mastery 6 / 7 / 8 / 9
Tactical	Martial	×1.2 army strength per level (×2.0 at 5, hard cap). Land and air units only, land battles only. Practising drills every land and air unit led (Green 5% / Average 4% / Veteran 3% / Crack 2% × level per practice, doubled for Humans). Each level takes −5% off a lone enemy's chance to slip past your sentries. Flank riders: Tactical + 1 cavalry.	none	Winning a land battle; losing and living (small)	No	Grand Marshal; Minor: The Strategist	6: Each unit you lead has a 10% chance to fight one experience tier higher in each battle. 7: New order — Feigned Retreat: bait an attacker, then counter at +strength. 8: Units you lead are 50% less likely to die or disband after losing a battle. 9: New order — Grand Stratagem: dictate the terms of one battle.
March	Martial	Adds land movement points to every unit led: +0/+1/+1/+2/+3 at levels 1–5. Counts three times toward initiative. Flyers ignore it.	none	Marching a column (small)	No	Minor: The Swift	6: Each army you lead adds +2% exploration to every province you move into. 7: New order — Forced March: march to an adjacent province with a 50% chance to slip past a battle this phase (once per turn). 8: All terrain combat bonuses for the units you lead are doubled, and they suffer no terrain penalties. 9: New order — Lightning Advance: a foe you attack this turn fights with no terrain bonus, no pre-battle magic and no pre-battle archery.
Naval	Martial	×1.2 per level to every fleet and sea-beast led (cap ×2.0), in every battle on land or sea. Sea movement +0/+1/+1/+2/+3 for every ship. Practising drills fleets. A hero with no ships always has 5 sea points.	none	Winning a sea battle; every voyage leading ships (passengers learn nothing); losing and living (small)	No	Sea Lord; Minor: The Sea-Wolf	6: Moving into a sea province while leading naval units adds +5% exploration to each adjacent land province. 7: New order — Blockade (needs a fleet): a 50% chance to seal a sea province so enemies may not cross it this turn. 8: Land units you lead take no penalty fighting at sea, and one naval hull now carries what once needed two. 9: New order — Raid the Coast (needs a fleet): an amphibious assault launched from the sea at +strength, plundering the province treasury if you capture it.
Sage	Special	Research rolls 5% per level (to 5); Neutral realms double. A success offers a choice of two discoveries. Practising Sage trains only.	Sage 1: the Research order	Making a discovery; a fruitless Research or using a magic item (small)	No	Loremaster; Minor: The Loreseeker	6: Gain +5 gold each time you make a new Sage discovery (discovery chance still caps at 5; your level counts toward the Loremaster title). 7: New order — Research Breakthrough: a guaranteed Sage discovery this turn. 8: Each new Sage discovery permanently raises the tax base of the province you are in by +1 (max 10). 9: New order — Grand Design: realise your alignment's unique realm-wide Wonder.
Spy	Special	Spy order succeeds at 20% + 20%/level (100% at 4). Stealth: an enemy's chance to spot you lurking in their province is 100 −20%/level of yours (to 5) +10%/level of their best Spy there, clamped 25–95%. Counter-watch on your own ground (+10%/level). Spying a capital can steal a discovery at 10% + 10%/level. Encounter catch 70% +5%/level −5%/theirs. Slip past sentries +5%/level. Ambush from Defend 10% + 9%/level.	none	A successful Spy order, a sprung ambush, running down a quarry, spotting a lurker; Hunting Rumours and a failed Spy (small)	No	Spymaster; Minor: The Shadow	6: Your spy actions now always succeed. 7: New order — Sabotage: wreck an enemy province (−tax / disband a garrison unit next turn). 8: Your spycraft deepens — infiltration grows surer. 9: New order — Assassinate: attempt to kill an enemy hero in a province you have infiltrated.
Thief	Special	Steal lands at 50% + 10%/level (to 5, cap 95%), halved against a commander with troops or a guarded paymaster. Getaway: Thief × 20%. Lair hoard: 10% of original gold per level; one item at 30% + 10%/level (cap 80%, never a relic). In-combat steal less the guardian's watchfulness (−15/30/45 by grade).	Thief 1: the Steal order	A Steal; stealing from a guardian in a fight; a failed Steal (small)	No	Minor: The Cutpurse	6: A personal stipend adds +5 gold to your income each turn. 7: New order — Grand Heist: once per turn, crack the vaults of the enemy capital or rich province you stand in — a quarter of that realm's treasury and a magic item off one of their couriers. 8: Gold you steal with a Grand Heist is doubled — you take the full amount even if the victim cannot cover it — and your own pockets can no longer be picked. 9: New order — Vanish: nothing can bring you to bay this turn — no pursuit, Encounter or ambush.

Skill	Group	What each level does (1–5)	Gates	Field experience (how it rises)	Items past 5?	Title it feeds	Mastery 6 / 7 / 8 / 9
Druid	Special	Lead other races and every wild thing: Druid 1 all humanoids and their fleets and winged riders; 3 Whale Cohort, Shark Shoals; 4 the Druid-4 beasts; 5 Elder Dragons, Crimson Rocs, Titan Warbeasts, Dread Hydras. Each missing level −20% on that unit. Mastery: +20% per level above the requirement, to +100%, counting to 9 (items included). A hero leads at most as many beasts as his Druid level. From Druid 3 a natural beast's blows land at half force against you. Beast special strikes land at 30% + 10%/level (cap 90%).	Druid 1: lead another race	Any battle with beasts on either side (loser half); leading newly recruited beasts; recruiting a beast anywhere (small)	Yes (to 9, every level counts)	Minor: The Naturalist	6: Creature and Monster units you lead cost half to recruit and draw half wages. 7: New order — Awaken Grove: raise a temporary Creature host from a forest or jungle you hold. 8: Creature and Monster units you lead fight one experience tier higher in every battle. 9: New order — Wild Calling: turn a whole wild (Creature or Monster) province's defenders to your side.
Explorer	Special	Each Explore charts (terrain base) × (level + 1) points, counted to 5: plains 35, desert 25, sea 25, forest 20, mountain 20, jungle 15.	none	An Explore order; first step into a province the realm has not fully charted (both small)	No	Cartographer; Minor: The Trailblazer	6: On entering a province you automatically spot one random undiscovered lair. 7: New order — Chart the Unknown: fully explore this province and reveal all its neighbours. 8: Each Explore action has a 50% chance to permanently raise the province tax base by +2 (max 10), once per province. 9: New order — Discover Lost Ruin: guaranteed to find and reveal a hidden lair or treasure site.
White Magic	Magic	Five core spells at level 1. Cast 30% + 10%/level (cap 95%). Action spells per turn 1/1/2/3/3 at levels 1–5; combat spells per fight 1 at level 1, 2 from level 2. Effects counted to 5. Items raise cast chance only, to 9.	Level 1: the school's spells	Every successful cast; a fizzle (small)	Yes (cast chance only)	Archmage, Hierophant; Minor: The Warlock	6: Mass Healing — at the end of every turn, all friendly characters sharing your province (you included) heal half their maximum HP. 7: New spell — Sanctuary: ward a province so enemy armies there fight at −strength. 8: +10% to your chance to cast ANY spell — stacks with the same L8 perk from your other magic schools (hard 95% cap). 9: New spell — Divine Judgment: smite a chosen enemy force for heavy holy damage.
Psychic Magic	Magic	As White.	Level 1: the school's spells	As White	Yes (cast chance only)	Archmage	6: Words of Awe — your Oratory raises the armies it inspires by TWO quality levels instead of one. 7: New spell — Mass Confusion: an enemy hero loses their Tactical command in their next battle. 8: +10% to your chance to cast ANY spell — stacks with the same L8 perk from your other magic schools (hard 95% cap). 9: New spell — Dominate: seize an enemy hero's orders, turning up to half their armies to your side.
Illusory Magic	Magic	As White.	Level 1: the school's spells	As White	Yes (cast chance only)	Archmage	6: Shimmer — enemy players are half as likely to see or find this character. 7: New spell — Phantom Host: duplicate the monsters and creatures you lead as phantom doubles that fight for the rest of the turn. 8: +10% to your chance to cast ANY spell — stacks with the same L8 perk from your other magic schools (hard 95% cap). 9: New spell — Veil: for two phases, you and your armies vanish from enemy sight and hostile magic.
Elemental Magic	Magic	As White.	Level 1: the school's spells	As White	Yes (cast chance only)	Archmage	6: Elemental Armour — in combat, every attack that lands on you is reduced by 1-3 HP. 7: New spell — Chain Lightning: strike several of an enemy hero's units at once. 8: +10% to your chance to cast ANY spell — stacks with the same L8 perk from your other magic schools (hard 95% cap). 9: New spell — Cataclysm: devastate a province — heavy damage to every enemy force, and it yields no tax.

Skill	Group	What each level does (1–5)	Gates	Field experience (how it rises)	Items past 5?	Title it feeds	Mastery 6 / 7 / 8 / 9
Necromancy	Magic	As White. Necromancy 1 also senses battlefield graves in every province entered and is required to hold a skeletal army at all.	Level 1: the school's spells; holding skeletons	As White	Yes (cast chance only)	Archmage, Deathpriest	6: The Necromantic Arts — every skeletal army you lead fights one experience tier higher in battle. 7: New spell — Raise Wraiths: raise the strongest battlefield dead as an elite Wraith whose Wraith's Touch withers the enemy's finest each battle. 8: +10% to your chance to cast ANY spell — stacks with the same L8 perk from your other magic schools (hard 95% cap). 9: New spell — Death's Dominion: mass-raise skeletal units from a battle's graves at once.

Rules that cut across every skill

Rule	What it is
Three caps	Levels 1–5 trainable; 6–9 only by experience; the raw benefit caps at 5 and levels 6–9 buy perks and Title points instead. Exceptions: Melee/Archery to-hit climbs +5% a level past 5, Melee/Archery damage reads the raw level, Druid counts every level to 9.
Initiative	Order of action within a phase = the sum of all fifteen levels, with March counted three times.
One rise per phase	A character gains at most one skill level per phase, chosen at random among the candidates (a Practice success always takes the phase). A skill rises from experience at most once a turn, and at most once across a battle and its carry-ons. Each Practice rise earlier in the turn makes the next experience chance ×0.8.
Practice (levels 1–5)	Alone: 25% (0 to 1), 20%, 15%, 10%, 5% (4 to 5). With a peer at the same level +50%. Under a more skilled mentor: automatic. Perseverance: each failed practice ×1.2 on the next this turn. Humans of a Human realm ×1.5.
Items	An item's skill levels stop at an effective 5 for Tactical, Naval, Sage, Spy, Thief, Explorer, March. Melee, Archery and the five schools stack to 9 (schools: cast chance only). Druid: every level counts.
Hit points	No skill raises max HP. HP is earned by fighting (see the Heroes sheet).
Zero gates	No Sage, no Research; no Thief, no Steal; no school level, no spells; no Druid, no leading another race or wild unit; no Necromancy, skeletons crumble at turn's end.
Wages	A hero's wage = total skill levels ÷ 4, rounded up, min 1g. Every four levels adds 1g.

Casting, by school level

Level	1	2	3	4	5	6–9
Cast chance (every spell, every use)	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	80% (items +10%/level to 95%; mastery L8 +10% per school)
Action spells per school per turn	1	1	2	3	3	3
Combat spells per school per fight	1	2	2	2	2	2
Spell effect level	1	2	3	4	5	5 (never higher)
New spells	all five core					one at 7, one at 9

Gaps, questions and things to check

These are observations from reading the data files, the engine and the rulebook together. None of them is a ruling. Each is a question for Toby or a place where two sources disagree.

#	Observation
1	March buys +0 at level 1 and +1 at level 2: the first point in March does nothing to movement (it still counts three times to initiative). Is a dead first level intended?
2	Explorer's per-level benefit is only exploration speed, and R-023 notes Explorer out-trains March in bot games. Halving its field rate is the open suggestion.
3	Spy 4 makes the Spy order certain (100%) before counter-measures, yet Spy 5 still raises stealth and catch rolls. The order's cap at 4 may be worth noting on the join screen.
4	Tactical never touches fleets and Naval never touches land troops except at sea penalties; a mixed landing uses both. The rulebook says this clearly; the join-screen blurb for March still talks about "contingent unify", which the Tactical/Good rules describe differently.
5	The join-screen Sage blurb says Sage "also raises your chance of encounters while exploring", which no engine rule does.
6	The five magic schools are described once ("as White") because their skill rules are identical; the difference is entirely in the spells (see the Spells sheet).
7	Melee and Archery are the only skills whose to-hit keeps rising past 5. A Melee 9 hero at 100% minus the 80% cap always hits a Berserk; the temper guard is the only thing left that matters. Check this against the guardian hard-to-hit perks.
8	The king's 4 starting points are capped at 2 per skill on the join screen; the rulebook does not say so.